

How do i reduce environmental impact and still use AI?

Posted by u/katismyname01 • 0 points • 9 comments

I try to be environmentally conscious and know that AI uses a lot of energy, but I'm reluctant to cut it out of my life entirely. Will it help if I ask a bunch of questions in one text? What can I do to reduce carbon emissions?

Comments

u/Aggravating-Play5388 • 1 points • 2025-11-14 16:44 UTC

You can lower AI's footprint without quitting it. For routine tasks, use small local models on your laptop (e.g., 7–8B via Ollama/LM Studio) and save big cloud models for when you truly need them.

Stick to text features, image/video generation is much heavier. Keep prompts short and focused, trim chat history, and avoid pasting huge documents; only “batch” questions if it actually prevents repeating the same context. Prefer retrieval or linking over dumping long text.

Choose providers that are transparent about data use and siting, and that let you opt out of training and control retention. Turn off extras like continuous/always-on agents or telemetry when you don't need them.

If you want a lighter cloud option, I came across Earthly Insight (www.earthlyinsight.com) it's text-first by design and channels a share of revenue to vetted rewilding projects as a complement (not a substitute) to reducing compute.

u/Odballl • 1 points • 2025-05-21 21:05 UTC

You could try to offset your use by not having kids? Lol.

People are right that individual usage is marginal but also, we're still contributing to the growth of environmentally unsustainable systems. But then again, I drive a car and like my smart phone so... I dunno.

Industrial-consumer society is - according to some researchers - already undergoing a slow process of collapse as we extract all the Earth's resources.

Hard to be morally upstanding when all this stuff is on-tap right now though. Or if you find it productive to your life.

u/PhantomJaguar • 1 points • 2025-05-21 19:31 UTC

ChatGPT uses less energy per day, per daily user, than running a small LED light all day.

It's easy to freak out because you see some big number, like 500,000 kilowatts, but forget that **they** are serving 122,500,000 million users per day^{**}. They will naturally use a lot of energy because of the sheer number of people involved. But the actual math comes out to about **0.0004 kilowatts per user^{**}**, which is a giant nothing burger.

u/Wes765 • -3 points • 2025-05-21 19:16 UTC

Stupid typical liberal

Why are you people so insane?
How do you live with yourselves?

u/katismyname01 • -1 points • 2025-05-21 19:25 UTC

In my house very comfortably. This was a question my friend has, so I posted it on her behalf since she doesn't have reddit. Thanks for your input. 😊

u/2Drex • 2 points • 2025-05-21 18:49 UTC

[AI usage has less environmental impact than claimed](<https://www.warpnews.org/artificial-intelligence/ai-usage-has-less-environmental-impact-than-claimed-2/>)

u/Key-Balance-9969 • 2 points • 2025-05-21 18:48 UTC

I have asked my GPT this specifically. It said don't worry about it. The way I use it especially, is not resource heavy. (Creative marketing strategies, image creation, answering industry questions, asking questions about the universe lol.) The tech guys running miles of code have more reason to be concerned, but that no one should really think too much on it. It said the OpenAI WANTS us to use it as much as we wish.

u/gamingkitty1 • 5 points • 2025-05-21 18:45 UTC

The environmental impact of ChatGPT is way overblown. A typical prompt uses 2.9 watt hours of energy. Comparing that to something like the average daily energy consumption of a home, 30 kwh, a chatgpt prompt only uses about 0.01% of that. So imo i wouldn't worry too much about it.

u/Glugamesh • 1 points • 2025-05-21 18:03 UTC

Use smaller models and combine your questions. Don't let the context window get too long.

u/Organic_Eggplant_323 • 0 points • 2025-05-21 18:02 UTC

Following bc this is also a concern I have

u/AutoModerator • 1 points • 2025-05-21 17:57 UTC

Hey /u/katismyname01!

If your post is a screenshot of a ChatGPT conversation, please reply to this message with the [conversation link](<https://help.openai.com/en/articles/7925741-chatgpt-shared-links-faq>) or prompt.

If your post is a DALL-E 3 image post, please reply with the prompt used to make this image.

Consider joining our [public discord server](<https://discord.gg/hT6PXe8gdZ>)! We have free bots with GPT-4 (with vision), image generators, and more!

🤖

Note: For any ChatGPT-related concerns, email support@openai.com

I am a bot, and this action was performed automatically. Please [contact the moderators of this subreddit](/message/compose/?to=/r/ChatGPT) if you have any questions or concerns.